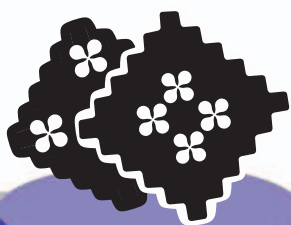


TEXTILE DESIGNER



SALARY

Newly qualified textile designer ★★★★★

Experienced textile designer ★★★☆☆

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Increasingly competitive sector, with more applicants than vacancies • Growing demand for textile designers in specialty markets, such as protective clothing and seating for car interiors

JOB DESCRIPTION

A textile designer designs woven, knitted, and printed textiles that are used to make clothes, fabrics, and furnishings. With an understanding of materials, dyes, patterns, and manufacturing processes, they produce designs for a range of decorative, durable, or protective fabrics. The work involves producing sketches and samples, and liaising with marketing and buying staff to make products that will sell.



AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Art • Craft • Fashion • Sewing • Knitting • Design technology • Mathematics • Chemistry • Information Technology (IT)



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree in textile or fashion design is desirable, but it is possible to learn on the job while working in the industry.



LIFESTYLE Regular office hours are the norm, but designers may have to work overtime to meet deadlines. Freelance designers can work from home.



LOCATION Work is primarily based in an office or studio; designers may need to visit factories during production, or attend client briefings and trade shows.



THE REALITIES The work is creatively rewarding. Most textile businesses are based in large cities, so relocation may be necessary to find a good position.

▼ RELATED CAREERS

► **JEWELRY DESIGNER** *see pp. 28–29*

► **CLOTHING AND TEXTILE TECHNOLOGIST** Manages the design, manufacture, and quality control of fabrics, yarns, and textiles. An expert in this field may work on fabrics for clothing, furnishings, medical supplies, or textiles for the car industry.

► **FURNITURE DESIGNER** Designs furniture pieces and fittings, such as cabinets. Some furniture designers work for manufacturers, creating designs for mass production; others produce items of furniture for individual clients.

In 2012, four million people were employed in the manufacturing of clothing and footwear in the United States.

